Josh Symonds

Hands-on staff engineer: agent platforms, evals and verification, and AI infrastructure.

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Built a company-wide agent platform and replay evals that moved its review to open-weight models, plus a decider model that replaced LLM-as-judge. Building by directing coding agents since 2025; 15 years in infrastructure and security.

Directs agents in: Go, Python, TypeScript · Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS, GCP · GitOps · Claude Code, MCP, model evals

EXPERIENCE

Attain — Remote

Director of SRE, Consumer Product — Mar 2026 - Present

- Marvin: Created Marvin, our company-wide agent platform in Slack; 116 people across engineering, support, and operations use it for code review, incident investigation, and internal workflows.
- Orchestration & Gateway: Designed Go/Kubernetes orchestration for ephemeral agent workers (per-user OAuth, Cedar policies, versioned model routes) and our LLM gateway with SSO keys, spend tracking, and zero-retention providers.
- Code Review: Shipped multi-stage AI code review with a verifier pass: 2,100+ reviews, 87% of 300+ ratings positive.
- Evaluation: Built a harness that replays production reviews against candidate models, with frozen dev/holdout cases and a version-pinned LLM judge. Blind review found the original verifier wrong on 37% of disputed calls. Moved review to open-weight models; with pipeline changes, cost per review fell 16× in a month and median review time halved.
- Incidents: Automated investigation of 2,170+ alerts; its fix merge requests are mergeable as written 95% of the time.
- Hiring: Designed Attain's AI-assisted SRE interview, graded mainly on how candidates work with a coding agent.

INDEPENDENT ENGINEERING, BUILT WITH CODING AGENTS

Savecraft — Go, TypeScript, Rust, WebAssembly, MCP · 2026

- Shipped an AI gaming companion for 14 games, in OpenAI's connector directory: sandboxed WASM save parsers on the player's device, and MCP tools and the chat loop on Cloudflare Workers behind OAuth 2.1.
- Built its eval system before choosing a model: 295 scenarios × 3 runs from production logs. A 13-model bake-off ranked an open-weight model first, ahead of frontier models costing 14× more. Replaced LLM-as-judge with a decider model (Jev) validated on held-out pairs, picking the stronger model in 95% of pairs vs 88% for the old judge ($p = 1.9e\text{-}17$).

Gambit & Tiltyard — Claude Code, Go

- Released Gambit, a Claude Code plugin that takes tasks from spec to release with test-evidence gates; Tiltyard replays real repository tasks to score models and agent harnesses.

LiveWorld (consulting) — AWS, EKS, Terraform, Flux · 2013 - Present

- Run its AWS/EKS platform and GPU inference for its ML product (Karpenter, KEDA); wrote its SOC 2/GDPR controls.

Open Source

Dynamoid (original author; 13M+ downloads) · nix-config (nine-host NixOS fleet; 837 stars)

PREVIOUS ROLES

CrossnoKaye — Santa Barbara, CA

Principal Infrastructure Engineer / Senior Manager, Core Services — Jan 2021 - Feb 2026

- Platform: Built the control plane and deploy tool (approval-gated, about 5,800 deploys in 2025), the end-to-end test framework, and the CLIs; ran 9 AWS accounts and 10 EKS clusters.
- Edge: Built the industrial IoT edge OS with zero-touch provisioning and over-the-air updates, and led the migration from k3os to Talos Linux as the fleet grew to 123 production deployments.
- Security & AI: Led SOC 2 Type 1; presented an IIAR paper on industrial cybersecurity; set the LLM usage policy, ran weekly "Cooking with Claude Code" workshops, and stood up self-hosted LLM inference for internal search.

Capital Markets Gateway — Chicago, IL

DevOps Engineer & CISO — Oct 2019 - Dec 2020

- Wrote Kubernetes operators and set up multi-region failover on AKS, wrote custom Terraform providers, and ran the NIST CSF and ISO 27001 programs that passed bank audits.

M1 Finance — Chicago, IL

Chief Information Security Officer — Aug 2015 - Oct 2019

- Employee #8. Built M1's infrastructure from launch to nearly $1B in assets (Chef, then self-run Kubernetes, then EKS) and ran security through SOC 2 and SEC, FINRA, and bank audits.

Education — University of Chicago, BA in East Asian Languages and Civilizations